

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)?

☐ Yes

☒ No

Contracting Activity: AFRL/PZLET

Project/Program Name: The IET (Institution of Engineering and Technology) – IET eBooks collection 2025 ebook collection

Purchase Request / Local ID Number:

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options):

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

In accordance with FAR 6.302-1, FAR 13.106-1(b), DAFFARS 5313.106-1(b) this is a justification for other than full and open competition for a sole source acquisition.

The AFRL Library Council requires access to The IET (Institution of Engineering and Technology) – IET eBooks collection (2025). The IET electronic books span all areas of engineering and technology, covering the disciplines of electrical, electronics, computing, control, biomedical and communications technologies. The IET electronic publications included in the subscription are necessary to allow the AFRL Library Council members (Arlington, VA, Edwards AFB, Eglin AFB, Fort Sam Houston, Kirtland AFB, Rome Research Site, Tyndall and Wright-Patterson AFB) to support the AFRL mission to "lead the discovery, development, and integration of warfighting technologies for our air, space and cyberspace forces." Access to these IET electronic publications enhances the broad access to scientific research that is crucial to the work done at the Air Force Research Laboratory and Air Force Institute of Technology.

The vendor quote is for the Air Force Research Laboratory libraries. The one-time cost for perpetual access (complete collection of research electronic books published by The IET in 2025 to The IET eBooks collection is \$25,920.00, based upon an official quote provided by the IET representative.

Period of Performance: Date of contract award to indefinite (perpetual access one-time purchase). This action will utilize FY25, 3600 R&D funds and 3400 O&M funds.

The total one-time cost for this acquisition is

Contract Type: FFP

Subscription License Activation Period: Perpetual License

Delivery: 7 days after receipt of order (ARO)

It will be awarded as a standalone purchase order

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

The IET (Institution of Engineering and Technology) - IET eBooks collection (2025) perpetual access is vital to the ongoing mission, outlined in detail in Section B, of AFRL to "lead the discovery, development and integration of affordable warfighting technologies for our air, space and cyberspace forces." There is no other collection of peer-reviewed academic literature covering the broad fields of electrical and electronics engineering research comparable to the copyrighted content of these publications provided by IET. The depth and breadth of their collection is an essential quality to the AFRL libraries' requirements. This subscription will need to meet the information needs of a wide variety of AFRL scientists and engineers (S&Es). The AFRL libraries support civilian, contractor, and military personnel, primarily scientists and engineers (S&Es), assigned to the eight AFRL technical directorates which include Aerospace Systems, Airman Systems, Directed Energy, Information, Materials and Manufacturing, Munitions, Sensors, and Space Vehicles, Tyndall and the Air Force Office of Scientific Research (AFOSR).

AFRL's requirement is for a subscription database that meets the demands of high level technical services. The subscription must offer the collection and services to meet the needs of a broad user base, provide high quality resources, and be accessible in all locations. The depth and breadth of The IET eBooks collection (2025) makes it the only feasible supplier that can meet the AFRL libraries' needs and provide customers with an all-inclusive electrical and electronics engineering literature collection.



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There are not comparable resources in the market that would cover all of these aspects of these fields in one place with the same functionality and access.

The information contained in these ebooks is one of a kind research critical to the overall mission entailed in AFRL -wide engineering education and research. No other vendor besides IET can provide the books in this requirement under the perpetual access terms required by the Air Force. Previous acquisitions of these IET collections are heavily well used by the researchers at AFRL and some have become required reading for graduate work at AFRL. There is no comparable resource available in other books.

Failure to acquire this IET eBook collection would force the AFRL libraries' staffs to either purchase single physical book copies at multiple library sites, spending government funds on duplicate copies, or attempt to borrow the physical volumes using the interlibrary loan process, which can be time-consuming and is dependent on other libraries owning and being willing to loan out the title(s). It is not possible to purchase these eBooks individually as single titles in electronic format, so failure to acquire the IET collection leaves physical book acquisition as the only option for the AFRL libraries.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

The IET has exclusive legal copyright to the interfaces and publications, requiring the transfer of copyright from the authors of each article, book, or chapter published. These sources are vital to the users of the AFRL libraries, and to the effectiveness of the technical database. The market research did not provide for any known replacement of the curated content provided by IET. IET is the only known source capable of providing the supplies for this requirement. Without this sole source acquisition, the AFRL libraries' users and staff will not have access to critical, one of a kind content.

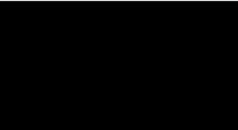
A sole source acquisition is justified because the books are not available elsewhere in the format and terms required. Although other professional organizations such as IEEE or Morgan & Claypool publish their own e-books in electrical and computer fields, there is no overlap with the works published in the e-books bought in this requirement from IET. The publisher, IET and its imprint companies, holds exclusive copyright to the content they publish. There is no other source for this information than the books in this requirement, nor any other books with the necessary research data included in these books.

Accordingly, the IET subscription is the only product capable of providing the supplies described in Section B above without the U.S. Air Force experiencing substantial costs that could not be expected to be recovered through competition.

Library staff surveyed the market for vendors to obtain competition in materials science publishing. The library used publisher's advertisements and new publication reviews in conducting its surveys, and was unable to identify publishers providing materials engineering information resources equivalent in scope and quality to those published by Springer Nature.

An intent to award on a sole source basis notice was posted on System for Award Management (SAM) and no qualified responses were received that could meet the requirement.

The proposed sole source is the only known source able to satisfy the Government's requirements.



Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

AFRL library staff will keep an open dialog with the users/patrons and evaluate usage statistics to determine the necessity of these resources to supplement its collection of electrical and electronics engineering research materials. AFRL librarians will continue to survey the market for vendors to obtain competition for future requirements. The library will also use publishers' advertisements, interlibrary loan requests, customer suggestions and new publication review in conducting its surveys.



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Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

